



— YOUR GUIDE TO THE ELECTRICITY BILL

Your electricity bill in Spain, explained

What every line means, why an empty home still has a bill and the simple changes that keep the cost of a holiday home under control.

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SIMPLIFIED

A bill that makes sense

A Spanish electricity bill can look complicated, especially in a language that is not your own. In fact it is built from a handful of parts that appear on every bill. Once you know them, you can check each one in a minute and see exactly where the money goes.

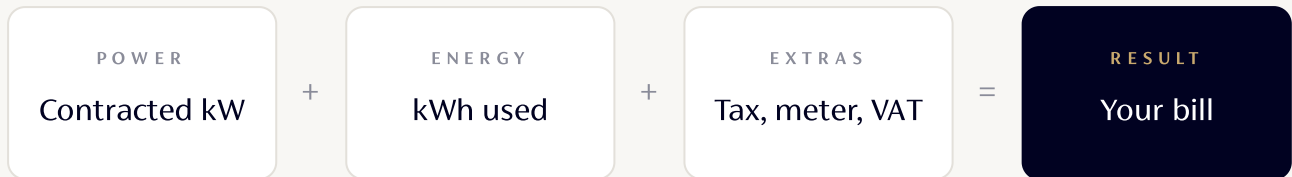
The essentials at a glance

- You pay for your contracted power every day, even when nobody is in the home.
- Right-sizing that power is the simplest way to lower the fixed part of the bill.
- A direct debit from a funded Spanish account keeps the supply safe while you are away.



How your bill is built

Every household bill in Spain has the same five parts. Two depend on your contract, and three are set by law.



Power term

The término de potencia is a fixed daily charge for your contracted kilowatts, however much you use.

Energy term

The término de energía is the kWh you used, multiplied by your price per kWh, which usually depends on the time of day.

Electricity tax

The impuesto especial sobre la electricidad is charged at about 5.11% on the power and energy terms.

Meter rental

About €0.81 a month to rent a standard smart meter.

VAT

21% on the whole bill, including the tax and the meter.

For homes up to 10 kW, VAT can be cut to 10% and the tax to 0.5% for a time when prices rise sharply, as from March to May 2026.

When you use power matters

Almost every home in Spain is on the 2.0TD access tariff, which covers contracts up to 15 kW. It splits energy into three price bands and power into two. The hours are the same on the mainland and in the Balearic Islands.

Peak, punta

10:00 to 14:00 and 18:00 to 22:00 on weekdays. These are the most expensive hours.

Standard, llano

8:00 to 10:00, 14:00 to 18:00 and 22:00 to midnight on weekdays.

Off-peak, valle

Midnight to 8:00 on weekdays, plus every hour of weekends and national holidays.

Two power periods

Power is priced in two periods, one covering peak and standard hours and one covering off-peak hours. Most homes contract the same number of kilowatts for both.

Single-price offers

Some suppliers offer one price for every hour of the day. It is simpler to follow, but it is not automatically cheaper, so compare it with your real pattern of use.

What it means for a holiday home

Appliances that run on their own, such as a water heater or a pool pump, can be moved to off-peak hours with a simple timer. Weekends are off-peak all day, which suits homes used mostly for short stays.

Regulated tariff or free market

You can buy electricity in two ways. Both use the same cables, the same meter and the same distribution company, so the supply itself is identical.

The regulated tariff, PVPC

It is open to homes with up to 10 kW and sold only by the reference suppliers, the comercializadoras de referencia. The price changes every hour. Since 2026, 55% of the energy cost follows longer-term market prices and 45% follows the daily market, which makes it steadier than before.

Free-market offers

Each supplier sets its own prices, often fixed per kWh for a year. They are easier to predict, but check the power price, the length of the contract and any extra services included.

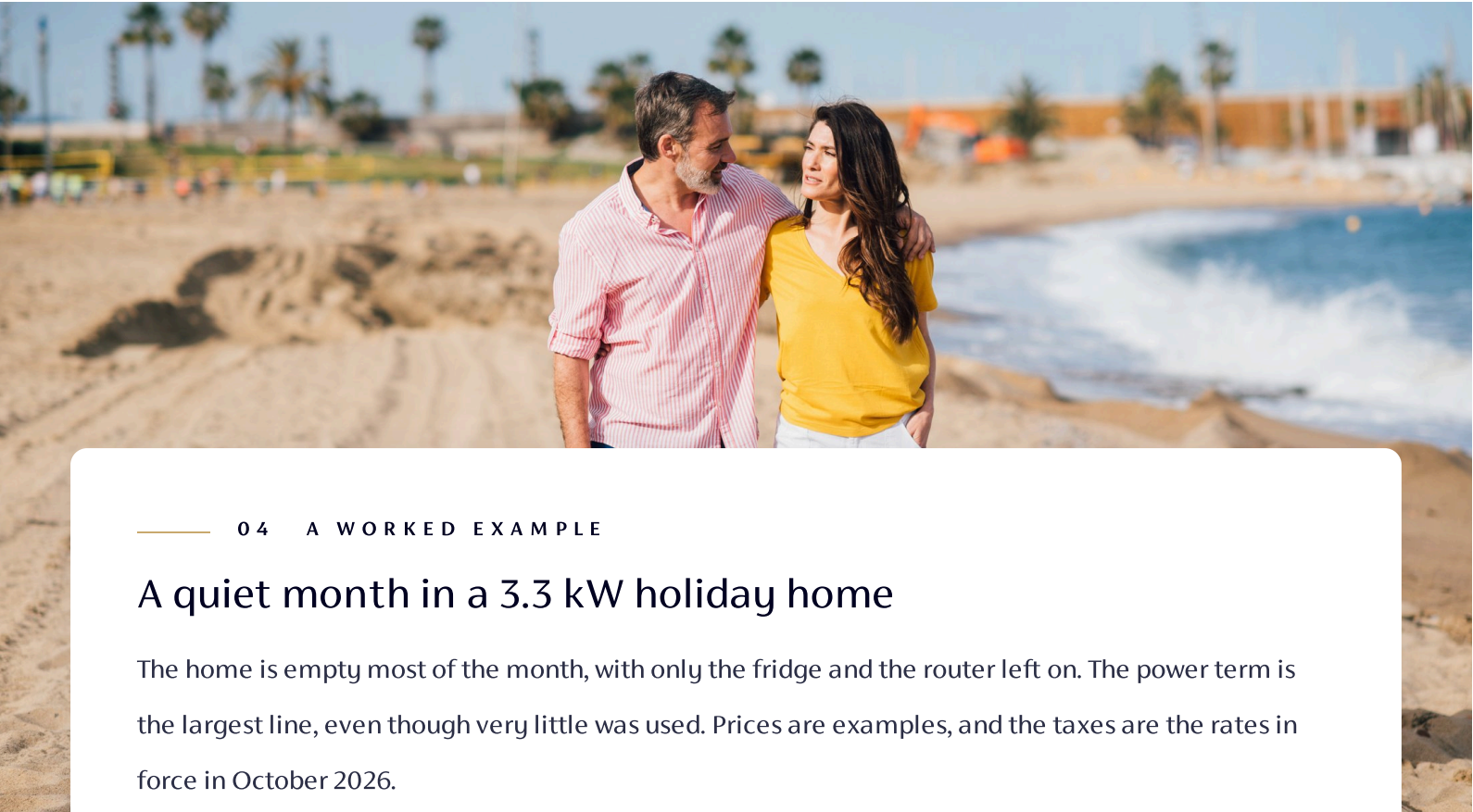
Switching supplier

Switching is free for household contracts. You sign with the new supplier, which handles the change, and it must be done within 10 business days, or 15 if work on site is needed.

What you need to switch

Have your current bill to hand for the CUPS code, the contract holder's details and the Spanish IBAN the new bill will be paid from.

The CNMC, the Spanish energy regulator, has a free online comparison tool that shows the PVPC alongside free-market offers for your own contracted power and use.



04 A WORKED EXAMPLE

A quiet month in a 3.3 kW holiday home

The home is empty most of the month, with only the fridge and the router left on. The power term is the largest line, even though very little was used. Prices are examples, and the taxes are the rates in force in October 2026.

Power term 3.3 kW for 30 days at €0.10 per kW per day.	€9.90
Energy term 60 kWh at €0.14 per kWh.	€8.40
Electricity tax 5.11% of the power and energy terms.	€0.94
Meter rental A standard smart meter for one month.	€0.81
VAT 21% of everything above.	€4.21
Total for the month	€24.26

€9.90 + €8.40 + €0.94 + €0.81 = €20.05, plus 21% VAT = €24.26. Example prices only.

Make the contract fit your home

A holiday home is often on a contract sized for a family living there all year. A few changes bring the fixed part of the bill down.

01 Check how much power you really use

Your supplier's or distribution company's online area can usually show the highest demand your smart meter has recorded. If it stays well below your contracted power, you are paying for capacity you do not use.

[START HERE](#)

02 Lower the contracted power if it fits

Ask your supplier to make the change. The distribution company charges a fixed fee of about €9 plus VAT. If too much then runs at once, the smart meter cuts the power until you switch something off.

03 Think before raising it again

The distribution company only has to accept a new change after 12 months. Raising power costs around €46 plus VAT for one extra kilowatt.

04 Switch off what runs while you are away

A water heater, an old fridge, a pool pump and anything on standby keep using energy in an empty home. Switch them off at the board or put them on a timer before you leave.

Where to find what matters

Layouts differ from one supplier to the next, but every bill shows the same key details. These are the ones worth checking each time a bill arrives.

CUPS	The unique code of your supply point. It starts with ES and stays with the home whoever the supplier is. You need it to switch or to change your power.
Contracted power	The kilowatts for each of the two power periods. Compare them with what you actually use.
Meter readings	The readings at the start and end of the period, and whether they are real or estimated. An estimate is corrected later, which can make one bill unusually high.
Contract details	The supplier, the distribution company to call about a fault, the contract holder and the date your offer price ends.
Payment	The amount due, the payment date and the IBAN the bill will be charged to.

Check that the IBAN on the bill is still the account you use. A bill charged to a closed or empty account will be returned unpaid.

Direct debit, and what happens if one is returned

Spanish suppliers usually collect the bill by direct debit, the *domiciliación bancaria*, from the account you give them. It is the simplest way to keep a home you are not living in fully paid up.

Keep the account funded

Bills often run higher in winter and summer, so leave a margin for the months you are away, and check the first bill after any switch is charged to the right IBAN.

If a direct debit is returned

A returned payment does not cut the power on its own. For homes with up to 10 kW, the rules give you time to put it right.

Returned

The bill stays unpaid. Contact the supplier, pay it and find out why it failed, such as a low balance or an old IBAN.

Formal demand

If it is still unpaid, the supplier must send a formal demand for payment that can be proved to have reached you.

2 months

Only when two months have passed since that demand can the supply be suspended. It cannot be cut on a holiday or the day before one.

24 hours

Once the debt is paid, the power must be reconnected within 24 hours. A reconnection fee is added.

Power sorted, bills paid

Bueno helps you choose the right electricity contract for your home and pays each bill from your Spanish IBAN, wherever you are.

01 Bueno Energy helps you compare offers and switch supplier.

02 Your electricity bill is paid by direct debit from your Bueno Account.

03 You see every payment in the app, wherever you are.

04 Our multilingual team explains any bill your home receives.

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